

LibreCAD: A Practical Tool For 2D Designs

Computer-aided design (CAD) software play an essential role in creating design sketches—be it for small lab projects or industrial applications. If you want to digitally draw designs for your project, LibreCAD comes as a handy CAD tool. Forked out from the QCAD Community Edition project, it can run on multiple operating systems including Windows, Linux, Unix, Mac OS and OS X. Written in C++, this free open source software is fully customisable with active support from the developer community. Documentation and guides are sufficiently available for users and developers alike.

Features

LibreCAD is easy to learn and simple to use. As it is inspired by the popular AutoCAD software, users' previous experience with this tool helps them start using LibreCAD straightaway. LibreCAD supports only 2D modelling with a graphical user interface based on Qt4 libraries. This maintains its operational consistency throughout all OS. LibreCAD supports AutoCAD DXF file format for import or save.

The overall interface is simple and organised. Drawing is done in the main black screen, which serves as the workspace. Multiple quick-access buttons throughout the interface allow smooth operations. The left panel has shortcuts to popular shapes like lines, circles and arcs, which can

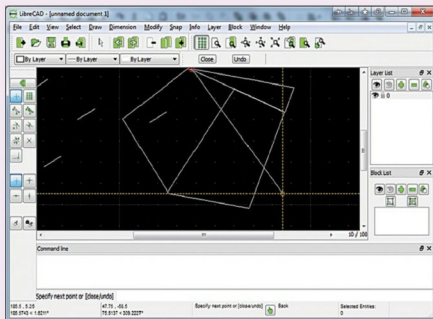


Fig. 1: The complete LibreCAD UI (Source: macworld.co.uk)

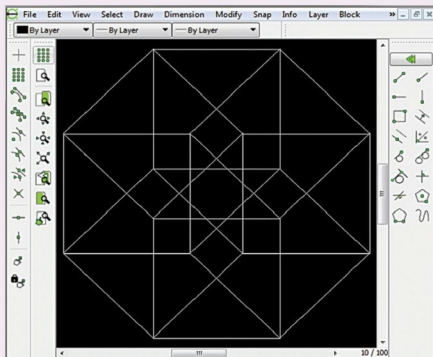


Fig. 2: Use of different line tools in LibreCAD